25900927 **MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM**

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION NOVEMBER 2025

FIRST SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC)

MG1DSCPSY100 – PSYCHOLOGY FOR PERSONAL GROWTH

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Part A Multiple Choice Questions

Multiple Choice Question- Choose the most appropriate answer. Answer all questions. Each question carries **1** marks

1. In ____ state, the gap between mediator and object of meditation is filled, and the mind is suffused with light, which evokes self- realization **[U] / [CO2]**

c) Samadhi

2. Which of the following is a strategy for developing self-confidence?**[An] / [CO3]**

a)Embracing new challenges and learning from failure

3. Which cognitive competence component involves filtering out irrelevant information? **[U]/[CO6]**

a). Attention

4. A patient presents with excessive daytime sleepiness, sudden sleep attacks, and cataplexy. These symptoms are most indicative of **[A]/ [CO4]**

b)narcolepsy.

5. Emotional maturity involves the ability to: **[U]/ [CO3]**

b). Regulate one's emotional responses effectively

6. Which among the following is a dimension of emotional competency **[K]/ [CO3]**

a). Social skills

7. Which one of the following is not a self-awareness questionnaire? **[K] / [CO3]**

c). Job Satisfaction Survey

8. If you were to design a training program on improving interpersonal communication, which of the following elements would be MOST essential? **[C] / [CO2]**

b). Providing training on listening, non-verbal communication, and feedback.

9. What is a recommended strategy for handling value conflicts? **[K]/[CO2]**

b). Listening to understand and acknowledging differing viewpoints

10. What is one potential outcome of effective social skills assessment? **[K]/[CO6]**

d). Improved social interactions

[1x10 = 10]

Part B

Short Answer type Questions Answer any **5** out of **7** Questions

Each Question carries **2** marks

11. Examine how the identification of external factors (Opportunities and Threats) help in self-improvement?**. [A] / [CO1]**

It helps in understanding favourable conditions for growth, anticipate and mitigate potential challenges.

12. Advantages of practicing mindfulness **[K]/[CO2]**

Mindfulness is the practice of becoming more fully aware of the present moment- non judgmentally and completely- rather than dwelling in the past or projecting into the future. It generally involves a heightened awareness of sensory stimuli and 'being in the now'. Mindfulness is generally used to indicate both: 1. A state or quality of mind. 2. A form of meditation that helps one to bring up and nurture this particular state or quality

Mindfulness helps reduce stress, increase self-awareness, and enhance emotional regulation.And it lowers levels of distress and leads to a greater sense of well-being. In general, mindfulness is associated with self-knowledge and well-being

13. Define self-concept **[K]/[CO1]**

Self-concept -An individual's perception of himself, which encompasses beliefs, thoughts, and perceptions about one's own abilities, appearance, and overall identity

14. What does each letter in "SMART" stand for?. **[U]/[CO5]**

Specific(Well-defined and clear)- Exactly what needs to be accomplished

Measurable- can be measured /Quantifiable- It allows for tracking progress and making adjustments

Achievable- A goal that can be accomplished with available resources and constraints

Relevant (or Realistic)- Relevant goal-A goal that aligns with broader objectives and values

Time-bound—ensures that goals are well-defined and attainable, enhancing the likelihood of success. A goal that includes a specific deadline or timeframe

15. What are Posthypnotic suggestions? **[K]/[CO2]**

Instructions about experiences or behaviour to take place after hypnosis has been terminated.

16.Analyse the key differences between waking consciousness and altered states of consciousness? **[An] / [CO4]**

Consciousness is your awareness of everything that is going around you and inside your own head at any given moment, which you use to organise your behaviour including your thoughts, sensations and feelings.Waking consciousness: Focused, logical, and organized; Altered States of Consciousness (ASC) is any condition which is significantly different from a normal waking state. ASC can occur naturally or be induced.

17. Mentions few ways to manage ones own emotion **[A] / [CO3]**

Managing emotions is the ability to manage and control one's emotional impulses, ensuring that responses to emotions are appropriate and measured rather than reactive or impulsive.

Self-awareness is foundational because it allows individuals to recognize their own emotional states, understand how their emotions affect their thoughts and actions, and make more informed, emotionally balanced decisions.

Emotional maturity plays a crucial role in conflict resolution as it allows individuals to approach disagreements with calmness, empathy, and problem-solving skills, rather than reacting emotionally. Emotional intelligence (EI) facilitates effective conflict management by providing the emotional tools needed to manage disputes effectively.

[5×2 = 10]

Part C

Short Essay Type Questions.Answer any **4** out of **6** Questions

Each Question carries **5** marks

18. Discuss the significance of the sleep cycle and how it changes throughout the night

[An / CO4]

The stages of the sleep cycle are vital for physical restoration, cognitive functioning, and emotional well-being. A complete sleep cycle lasts about 90 minutes, encompassing NREM and REM sleep. Individuals progress through multiple cycles, starting with longer periods of deep NREM sleep (N2 and N3), crucial for physical recovery and immune function. As the night continues, REM sleep durations increase, aiding memory consolidation and emotional processing. This cyclical pattern allows the body to balance restorative processes and cognitive functions, which is essential for overall health.

19. Demonstrate the benefits of mindfulness practices in managing difficult emotions

[U / CO3]

Mindfulness-based interventions are highly effective in managing difficult emotions as they encourage non-judgmental awareness of present-moment experiences. Studies show that these interventions reduce emotional reactivity and increase emotional regulation by promoting acceptance and reducing the tendency to ruminate on negative experiences

20. How does metacognition improve learning outcomes? **[U/ CO3]**

Metacognitive knowledge- awareness of one's own thinking processes, crucial for effective learning and self-regulation. Developing metacognitive skills is essential for students as it fosters self-awareness, adaptability, and improved control over their learning, leading to greater academic success.Metacognition improves learning outcomes by enabling individuals to plan, monitor, and evaluate their thinking processes, leading to more effective and self-directed learning.Also to adjust strategies as needed.

21. Explain effective time management techniques and describe how can they

improve goals setting processes **[A / CO5]**

Eisenhower Matrix -Also known as Urgent - Important Matrix- The method helps to prioritize tasks by urgency and importance while sorting out less urgent and important tasks that you should either delegate or not do at all

Time management techniques is focused on time intervals - **Pomodoro technique**

Time Blocking -Scheduling specific blocks of time for different tasks or activities. It's a simple time management technique that helps you become aware and strategic of how you spend your time. In time blocking, you divide your day into chunks of time—time blocks.

The **Pareto principle**, also known as the 80/20 rule, states that 80% of outcomes come from 20% of causes

The **ABCDE** method is a time management technique where tasks are categorized based on their urgency and importance, with "A" representing the most urgent and important tasks that should be done first, and "E" representing the least important tasks that can be eliminated or delegated; A (most important), B (important), C (nice to do, task with no consequences), D (delegate), or E (eliminate whenever possible).

Some students may include (planning, scheduling tasks etc)

22. State the relationship between intimacy and self disclosure in close relationship **[U / CO2]**

Intimacy-It is a deep emotional connection between two people. It involves feelings of closeness, warmth, and understanding.

Intimate relationships are characterized by **mutual trust, respect, and support**.

Self–disclosure in and of itself did not generally predict relational quality or stability. Although disclosure is an important relational behavior, it may be that self–disclosure acts in concert with other variables to influence relationship continuation or termination. Thus, self–disclosure may need to be combined with other constructs in order to be a strong predictor of relationship quality.

23. Describe the vicious cycle of procrastination **[An / [CO5]**

Procrastination refers to the voluntary delay of an intended action despite knowing that it might lead to negative consequences.

Approach Task/Goal,Unhelpful Rules/Assumptions Activated,Discomfort Driven,Procrastination Excuses,Procrastination Activities, Consequences, Continue To Procrastinate Next Time

[4x5 = 20]

Part D

Essay type Questions Answer any **2** out of **3** Questions

Each Question carries **15** marks

24. Discuss about the various theories of dreaming. **[U] / [CO4]**

Psychoanalytic,activation synthesis
One of the ways Freud devised to get at these early memories was to ex amine the dreams of his patients, believing that conflicts, events, and desires of the past would be represented in symbolic form in the dreams.**Manifest & Latent content in dream-** The manifest content of a dream is the actual content of the dream itself

According to the **activation-synthesis theory of dreaming**, the pons in the brainstem sends random signals to the upper part of the brain during REM sleep.

Hobson and colleagues have reworked the activation-synthesis hypothesis to reflect concerns about dream meaning, calling it the **Activation-information-mode model**, or AIM (Hobson et al., 2000). In this newer version, information that is accessed during waking hours can have an influence on the synthesis of dreams

Some may also describe information processing and problem solving theory

25. What is self confidence? Critically examine the theories and strategies of self confidence? **[K] / [CO3]**

Self-Confidence- belief in one's own abilities, qualities, and judgment, enabling individuals to take risks and face challenges with a positive mindset.

Theories and strategies of self confidence- Adlerian, self concept, self efficacy, growth mindset theory

Adlerian Theory of Self-Confidence Psychologist Alfred Adler's theory suggests **that early experiences shape how people view themselves and the world**. Children who are bullied or marginalized may have difficulty with self-confidence and self-esteem as adults.
Self-concept Theory Carl Rogers' theory suggests that self-confidence is closely linked to self-concept, which is the perception and beliefs people have about themselves**. Self-concept is shaped by experiences, feedback, and social interactions**.
Psychologist **Albert Bandura's** theory suggests that self-confidence is a **cognitive mechanism** that influences people's motivation, thought patterns, emotional reactions, and behavior. Self-efficacy is the belief that one can succeed in specific situations or accomplish a task.
Growth mindset theory of self confidence- individuals who believe their abilities and intelligence can be developed through effort and learning are more likely to cultivate self-confidence and resilience in the face of challenges.

Psychologist **Carol Dweck's** theory suggests that people can improve their abilities and skills through **effort, feedback, and learning**. People with a growth mindset see challenges as opportunities to grow

26. If you were to design a social competence training program for college students, what essential components would you include? Justify your choices with psychological theories and research.. **[E] / [CO2]**

An intervention program to enhance social competence should focus on:

Training in Communication Skills – Conducting workshops on active listening, assertive

communication, and non-verbal cues.

Role-Playing and Group Activities – Encouraging participation in simulated social scenarios to practice handling real-life interactions.

Emotional Regulation Techniques – Teaching mindfulness, stress management, and coping mechanisms for handling anxiety in social settings.

Conflict Resolution Strategies – Helping students develop problem-solving techniques to address misunderstandings and disagreements constructively.

Building Peer Support Networks – Creating mentorship or buddy programs to foster a sense of belonging and inclusivity.

By incorporating these strategies, students can develop stronger interpersonal skills, improve confidence in social settings, and enhance their overall well-being.

[2 x15 = 30]